

Xiaochuan Zha (Tran)

Engineering Manager | Platform Modernisation | Technical Leadership | Brisbane, Australia

info@tranzha.com | 0402 798 180 | linkedin.com/in/tranzha | github.com/trannzfsg |

trannzfsg.github.io/resume

Professional Summary

Engineering Manager with 15+ years of experience building software products, leading teams and modernising complex platforms. I help teams make sense of messy legacy systems, turn unclear problems into practical delivery plans, and keep business-critical work moving without losing sight of quality. Strong in technical judgement, stakeholder alignment, team coaching, delivery planning and long-term platform improvement. I also use AI/LLM tools in personal projects and day-to-day engineering work to speed up research, prototyping, documentation and analysis, while keeping human review and engineering judgement at the centre.

Leadership & Technical Strengths

- **Engineering leadership:** Team coaching, delivery ownership, expectation-setting, hiring support, career development and performance conversations.
 - **Platform modernisation:** Strangler Fig migration, monolith decomposition, backward compatibility, facade/service boundaries and legacy risk reduction.
 - **Architecture judgement:** CQRS, event-driven design, gRPC/internal APIs, clean architecture, VSA, domain modelling and integration patterns.
 - **Product & stakeholder alignment:** Discovery, roadmap trade-offs, executive communication and cross-team dependency management.
 - **Complex product domains:** CRM platforms, contacts, ownership, authorisation, reporting, migrations, workflow-heavy systems and sensitive data handling.
 - **AI-assisted engineering:** Uses LLMs for discovery, prototyping, test ideas, documentation, technical analysis and rapid product experimentation with human review.
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Recent Platform Programs

LMG / Loan Market Group - Engineering Manager, MyCRM Replatforming

Feb 2023 - Present

Contact Replatform - centralising contact ownership, mutation and retrieval | Jun 2025 - Present

- Leading the highest-complexity MyCRM replatform initiative: contacts are entangled across more than half of the monolith's business logic, with historical edge cases and patches spread across screens, workflows and services.
- Building Contact v2 with backward compatibility and future-facing architecture, while untangling fragmented product logic into centralised mutation/retrieval paths and clearer ownership/auth boundaries.
- Using a Strangler Fig approach: facade over the existing data store first, gradual migration of legacy consumers, then replacement of the underlying data model once behaviours are controlled.
- Positioning Contact as a reference architecture for future MyCRM work, applying CQRS, domain and integration events, gRPC internal communication, clean architecture, Vertical Slice Architecture and stronger service boundaries.
- Partnering with product, architecture and frontend teams to introduce a new Material UI based design system while preserving legacy interoperability during migration.

Diversified Deals Replatform - generic engagement model for financial deals | Feb 2023 - Jun 2025

- Led replatforming of residential-focused deal capability into a generic Engagement model that can support multiple product types and future residential migration.
- Used the Engagement platform to launch asset finance, commercial and insurance deal journeys, expanding MyCRM beyond residential lending without duplicating core deal logic.
- Drove domain modelling, transition planning, roadmap alignment and stakeholder trade-offs across product, engineering and business groups.
- Reset expectations and delivery discipline in a struggling team, improving clarity, technical direction and execution focus across a long-running replatform program.

AI/LLM-Assisted Personal Projects

- **mqcyb.tranzha.com - Math Quiz / mqcyb:** Flutter learning app previously released on the App Store; used AI assistance for rapid feature iteration, UI refinement and content generation support.
- **transtags.tranzha.com - Bank transaction categorisation and tax returns:** React/Node.js product experiment for importing bank transactions, categorising spending and preparing tax-return exports; explored Supabase before pausing the project.
- **sports.tranzha.com - Community sports registration and mini CRM:** Next.js/Node.js/Firebase app for registrations, participants and lightweight community operations management.

- **Roblox Autorun Obby:** Roblox game/prototype using AI-assisted scripting, level iteration and gameplay experimentation.
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Engineering Management Evidence

- Creates clarity in ambiguous programs by turning messy domains into decision points, delivery roadmaps, migration strategies and cross-team responsibilities.
 - Balances product pressure with technical risk, especially where legacy behaviour, backward compatibility, security, data ownership and stakeholder expectations compete.
 - Improves team operating rhythm through expectation-setting, coaching, scope control, dependency management and stronger engineering standards.
 - Communicates complex architecture and delivery trade-offs to engineers, product leaders and senior technology stakeholders in practical business terms.
 - Uses AI/LLMs pragmatically for discovery, prototyping, documentation and technical analysis while preserving human review, system understanding and quality guardrails.
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Earlier Experience

LMG / Loan Market Group - Engineering Manager, One Commission System / Business Insights / Risk Insurance / Podium Migration

Mar 2021 - Apr 2023

- Built and led teams across commissions, reporting/analytics, risk insurance uplift and acquisition migration programs; shaped business cases, roadmaps, discovery and delivery plans for complex domains.
- Evaluated Snowflake, Starburst, ThoughtSpot, BigQuery, Sisense and related platforms; separated data lake/warehouse concerns and delivered ingestion, transformation and reporting pipelines.
- Led migration work after acquisitions, including one-off and overnight delta pipelines using SSIS, TaskFactory, Salesforce, Kubernetes jobs and AWS services; supported onshore growth from 10+ to 30+ engineers.

LMG / NZFSG - Senior DevOps Engineer / Senior Engineer / Engineering Manager, MyCRM Launch and Cloud Modernisation

Apr 2016 - Apr 2021

- Helped rebuild, launch and modernise MyCRM across Australia/New Zealand; migrated from Windows/IIS/on-premise patterns toward AWS, Kubernetes/EKS, CI/CD and improved operational observability.

- Introduced OpenTelemetry, contextual logging, GitHub Actions, Octopus and improved local development workflows; coordinated security audit activity and supported offshore expansion from 0 to 20+ engineers.

LifeDirect / Inform Holdings / Trade Me - Software Engineer

Jul 2008 - Mar 2016

- Full-stack engineering across online insurance, internal admin, reporting, CRM and hosting operations; built quoting, application and underwriting workflows and mentored team members as the function grew.

Technical Toolkit

C#/.NET, SQL Server, PostgreSQL, React, TypeScript, Material UI, Next.js, Node.js, Flutter, Firebase, Supabase, AWS, EKS/Kubernetes, Docker, GitHub Actions, Octopus, OpenTelemetry, Elasticsearch, Snowflake, BigQuery, ThoughtSpot, SSIS, Serverless, gRPC, CQRS, event-driven architecture.

Education, Coursework & Languages

Postgraduate Diploma in Science, Computer Science - University of Auckland | Bachelor of Science, Computer Science - University of Auckland | Bachelor of Commerce, Finance and Economics - University of Auckland

AWS Solutions Architect Associate coursework completed (A Cloud Guru); Kubernetes Administrator coursework completed (Udemy); Machine Learning and Deep Learning coursework completed (Coursera/deeplearning.ai); Certified Scrum Master | English, Mandarin | References available on request